

Getting started with n8n

n8n is a powerful, low-code, fair-code workflow automation tool that connects applications to automate tasks. It allows users to create visual workflows by dragging and dropping nodes, which handle API calls, data manipulation, and triggers. Key concepts include **nodes** (individual actions), **triggers** (workflow start points), and **workflows** (the complete automation process).

Getting Started with n8n

1. **Choose Hosting:** You can start instantly with the n8n cloud plan, or self-host via Docker for free.
2. **Define a Trigger:** Start a workflow with an event (e.g., a webhook, a scheduled time, or a form submission).
3. **Add Nodes:** Chain actions such as sending emails, posting on social media, or interacting with tools like Notion, Gmail, or AI models.
4. **Connect and Test:** Use the visual editor to link nodes, set up API credentials, and test your workflow.

Common Usage Examples

- **AI Automation:** Creating a chatbot that queries local data or using AI for sentiment analysis in emails.
- **Data Synchronization:** Automatically updating Google Sheets or Notion when a new form is submitted.
- **Alerting & Messaging:** Sending automated Slack or Discord messages when specific tasks are completed.

- **Scheduled Tasks:** Sending automated daily, weekly, or monthly reports via email.

Key Concepts and Synonyms

- **Nodes:** The building blocks/steps of a workflow.
- **Workflow:** The automated scenario or sequence of events.
- **Canvas:** The visual editor/workspace.
- **Trigger:** The "if this happens" initiator.
- **Expressions:** Used for data manipulation in nodes.
- **Credentials:** API keys/authentication for app connections.

You can start by using n8n templates for faster development.